PORTFOLIO

Darina Mikhalina



Strategy · Events · Experience

Building the operational foundation for cultural projects and professional formats.

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5.0 / 5.0	1 / 26	10+ Yrs.	15+ Mo.	60,000
ACADEMIC GPA	CLASS RANK	PERFORMING ARTS	OFFICIAL EMPLOYMENT	PEAK AUDIENCE REACH

01 / APPROACH

From insight to structure.

01 Perception

Working with teenagers, seniors, and creative professionals across projects of different scales has shown me how differently people can perceive the same environment. What feels intuitive to one group may create friction for another. Rather than relying on assumptions, I pay attention to how people actually experience a setting, format, or interaction.

02 Systems

Complex projects rarely depend on one decision alone. Their outcomes emerge from the way roles, timing, information, and constraints interact. Working on projects of varying complexity has made me interested in these connections: where processes become inefficient, how small changes affect the wider picture, and what makes a structure resilient when circumstances shift.

03 Purpose

I want to take this way of thinking beyond individual projects. What I need now is a formal liberal arts foundation: structured study of how decisions are made at scale, how organizations grow and adapt, and how ideas become viable initiatives. I see this as the next step in my development: combining creative judgment with a more analytical approach.

02 / FOUNDATION

What drives my readiness.

ACADEMIC PROFILE & SPECIALIZED COURSEWORK

5.0 / 5.0 Unweighted GPA

- Class Rank: 1 / 26 students (GPA: 5.0 / 5.0)
- Specialized Psychology & Education curriculum at School No. 21, St. Petersburg, Russia. 2025-2026
- Finalist in Academic Olympiads in Financial Literacy, Economics, Social Studies, and Business Fundamentals 2026.
- Coursework covering organizational behavior and conflict management 2026.

PDF →

LEADERSHIP & NEGOTIATION

Debate & mediation

- First Speaker & Debate Leader in competitive brackets featuring 2,000+ multi-regional participants. 2025
- St. Petersburg City Mediation Tournament Winner (Individual & Team titles). 2026
- Youth Law Enforcement Rally & Spartakiad Competitor — applied legal frameworks, conflict resolution, and group dynamics in team challenges. 2026

PDF →

PRACTICAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Official employment & volunteering

- 9 months choreographic assistant 2024-2025
- 6 months school assistant 2025-2026
- 7-Year Modern Dance Diploma with official state authorization for children's dance instruction. 2018-2025
- Registered Volunteer supporting elderly stage performers and inclusive community initiatives (120+ hours).

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE & SCALE

10+ Years inside performing arts

- Extensive experience across major venues: Gazprom Arena (60,000+) BKZ Oktyabrsky Concert Hall (3700+), the State Theatre of Musical Comedy, and others.
- Knowledge of arena crowd dynamics, multi-camera production logistics, and live televised broadcasts.
- Experience in event organization and on-site delivery.

PDF →

03 / SELECTED WORK

Many projects. One direction.

FOUNDER & PROJECT LEAD · DIGITAL SERVICE

JobSPB
Youth employment service

Designed and launched a digital service translating complex legal and bureaucratic hiring procedures into actionable, structured guidance for teenagers. Grounded in a two-stage empirical study (55-respondent baseline assessment and 103-respondent post-use evaluation), the project addresses young job seekers' specific information gaps through a targeted digital platform and a multimedia video guide.

JobSPB website | Case on site · Guide · Presentation | Project PDF

01

91.3% User clarity
hiring rules became clear and easy to follow, earning a 4.32 / 5 usability

48.5% Action rate
prompted users to start job searches, send applications, or get hired

78.7% Real help
helped teenagers navigate complex labor regulations with confidence

Product logic
research → user needs → service design → implementation → measurement

PROGRAM DEVELOPMENT & OPERATIONS · EDUCATION & CULTURE

SPB IEF
Venue operations & visitor experience

My work at the Saint Petersburg International Educational Forum ranged from creating an original dance film in 2024 to leading concept development, program structure, and operational coordination for a major school-led section in 2026. This project served as a practical case in resource coordination, visitor flow management, and scalable event execution.

Case on site · Media

02

Program development
structured a repeatable, engaging format for successive visitor groups

200+ guests
end-to-end visitor coordination and venue logistics

Stakeholder alignment
managed teams, schedules, and interactive engagement loops

Operational efficiency
outperformed traditional delivery models through interactive design

#1 Most-Visited School-Led Venue at SPb IEF 2026

PERFORMER & PRODUCTION PARTICIPANT · PROFESSIONAL LIVE EVENTS

Large-scale live events & broadcast production

First-hand experience across major arenas and televised productions provided deep operational awareness. Working within high-pressure environments taught me how massive live projects coordinate multiple moving parts under strict timelines.

Case on site · Media

03

60,000 capacity
direct exposure to arena-scale live logistics and execution

Multi-stakeholder environment
synchronized crews, artists, technical teams, and security

Contingency management
real-time problem solving and timing in high-pressure settings

Core takeaway
large creative visions succeed only when operational logistics run flawlessly

EVENT COORDINATION · SCHOOL PROJECTS

School events producing & interactive formats

Hands-on experience turning ideas into structured programs for different school audiences. I developed scripts and choreography, coordinated participants and rehearsals, and designed interactive formats including demonstration lessons, intellectual quizzes and quest-based tours. Experience as a debate leader and peer mediator strengthened my ability to lead teams and work across different perspectives.

Case on site · Media

04

End-to-end ownership
from concept and program design to final delivery

Team leadership
coordinated 15–25 person teams through rehearsals and performance

Resource management
worked within fixed school budgets for costumes, lighting and logistics

Process improvement
refined planning, coordination and audience engagement with each edition

SOCIAL IMPACT & RESEARCH

Inclusive cultural experiences

LOGOS is a dance project exploring how gestures can speak louder than words (3rd Place, Sozhsky Karagod International Festival). Additionally, I have performed in Brys at the State Theatre of Musical Comedy, a production advocating for stray animals with tickets distributed through charities. I have also contributed to volunteer shows for retired actors in a nursing home.
My research on disability inclusion showed that every project should consider diverse needs.

Case on site · Media | Inclusion research project PDF

05

LOGOS project
non-verbal communication through dance

50+ performances
professional stage experience and charitable outreach

Cross-sector experience
theatre + charities + nursing homes

Driving purpose
accessibility as an essential standard for audience engagement

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